



tricks

mind-boggling magic tricks!

Secret sixes

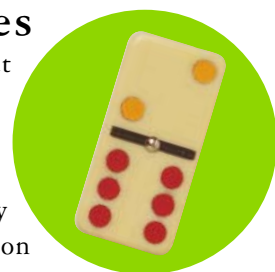
Here's a game you can play with a friend and always win. Ask a friend to tell you any number from 1 to 5. You then choose a number from 1 to 5 and add them. Carry on doing this until one person wins by reaching 50. Here's how to make sure you win. At the first chance you get, make the total equal any of these numbers: 2, 8, 14, 20, 26, 32, 38, 44. So if your friend starts with 3, you add 5 to make 8. Now whatever number they choose, you add the number that makes it up to 6 and the new total will be 14. In this way, you're certain to be the one who reaches 50.



Magic dominoes

Ask a friend to choose a domino at random from a set of dominoes, without showing you the number. Now tell them to multiply one of the two numbers by 5, add 7, multiply by 2, and add the other number on the domino. Ask for the final answer.

You can now work out what the domino is. Simply subtract 14 from the answer to give you a two digit number made up of the two numbers on the domino.



date of birth appear
a calculator!

- Subtract 40
- Multiply by 50
- Add the last two digits of the year they were born
- Subtract 10,500

Ask to look at the calculator and then tell them their full date of birth. The *first* one or two digits gives the month, the next two gives the day, the last two gives the year.

Impossible pairs

In this amazing trick you make a volunteer shuffle a pack of cards, yet the cards magically arrange themselves into pairs. First do some sneaky preparation. Arrange the pack so that it's made of alternating red and black cards. Now you're ready.

Ask a volunteer to cut the pack and do a "riffle shuffle", using their thumbs to flick the two piles together. It doesn't matter how badly they do the shuffle. Take the pack back and briefly show the cards to the audience – they'll look random. Now say you're going to split the pack at its "magic point". Look for two cards the same colour. Split the pack between them and bring the bottom half to the top. Now comes the finale. Deal out the cards face up in pairs. Every pair will contain one red and one black card. This trick works every time. Can you see why?

